

Manasa Sama

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Data engineer with an MS in Technology Innovation (product, design, and user research) and 3.5 years building data products and client-facing analytics solutions. Published product research (IEEE GHTC, PETRA); Dempsey Startup Competition finalist.

EXPERIENCE

Data Engineer, Data Analytics

Sept 2024 – Present

Fresche Solutions, Seattle, WA

- Productized data solutions now sold to clients — including Salesforce, NetSuite, and Kantata integrations — by converting internal frameworks (OA FSCM, OA BC Cloud) into reusable, scalable offerings.
- Launched self-service analytics with natural-language Data Agents and consolidated reporting, enabling non-technical stakeholders to gain actionable insights without engineering support.
- Architected and maintained 15+ scalable ETL pipelines (PySpark, SQL) with governance across 10M+ records, automating ingestion, transformation, formatting, and data-quality checks.
- Built platform-level systems for capacity management, alerts, notifications, and reusable code frameworks — improving operational efficiency and speeding up developer onboarding.

Associate Data Engineer, Data & AI (Intern, Jun – Sept 2023)

Oct 2023 – Sept 2024

OmniData, Seattle, WA

- Shipped product features for OmniAnalytics on Azure (Data Factory, Synapse, Databricks); increased product performance and scalability by 50% through parallelization, threading, and partitioning.
- Resolved 30+ client issues and improved product quality 40% using Azure Stream Analytics and Event Hubs.
- Automated conversion of 100+ serverless tables to Delta tables and enabled AI data export/import for 6+ reports (Python, SQL).

Product Developer, UW Capstone

Jun 2022 – Dec 2022

Microsoft Research, Seattle, WA

- Led development of an ML-based MVP for wildfire occurrence prediction over big data, working in a team with UX designers, front-end, and ML engineers.
- Negotiated with business stakeholders to ship user-facing features: 3D mapping, bookmarking of wildfire-prone areas, and enhanced data visualization.
- Engineered a real-time data pipeline optimizing satellite data processing to improve map load times and user experience.

SELECTED PRODUCT WORK

- **Foreflame (sponsored by Microsoft Research):** Product manager, designer, and launch lead for a wildfire occurrence prediction system. Ran user research with WA State Dept. of Natural Resources emergency management; built the medium-fidelity prototype and Figma wireframes. Finalist: Alaska Environmental Innovation Challenge; Dempsey Startup Competition investment round.
- **quEASY:** Product designer and IoT developer: a tilting mobile interface that reduces car motion sickness. Ran usability testing and validated consumer feasibility of a research-backed solution. Published and presented at IEEE GHTC 2022 and PETRA 2022.
- **RememVR (supported by UW Medicine):** Product designer and full-stack IoT developer: gamified VR cognitive testing. Interviewed users, doctors, and caregivers to identify pain points; built a Flask/Python clinician dashboard — shortening the diagnosis period.

EDUCATION

MS in Technology Innovation – Connected Devices

Sept 2021 – Mar 2023

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

- Interdisciplinary program: user research, design thinking, data structures, programming, product planning, decision-making, and the social impact of technology.

BTech in Electronics and Communication Engineering

2016 – 2020

Vidya Jyothi Institute of Technology, Hyderabad, IN

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Engineer Associate · Azure Developer Associate · Fabric Analytics Engineer Associate · Azure Fundamentals
- Python · SQL · PySpark · Azure (Data Factory, Synapse, Databricks, Fabric) · Machine Learning · Data